

Chapter

Agriculture

1. Which of the following farming method is used to grow tea on a large scale?

MAIN 2024

- (a) Subsistence farming
- (b) Plantation farming
- (c) Mixed farming
- (d) Shifting agriculture

2. Wheat and barley are associated with which agricultural season? SQP 2024

- (a) Kharif
- (b) Zaid
- (c) Rabi
- (d) None of the above

3. The___content in sugarcane decreases if heavy rains continue for long time.

SQP 2024

- (a) glucose
- (b) fructose
- (c) sucrose
- (d) lactose

4. Which of the following is NOT a problem of Indian agriculture? MAIN 2023

- (a) Dependence on monsoon
- (b) Small land holdings
- (c) Two main cropping seasons
- (d) Use of traditional methods of farming

5. Which of the following is a staple food grain of Indians? MAIN 2023

- (a) Wheat
- (b) Rice
- (c) Gram
- (d) Arhar

6. State any two advantages of Commercial farming. MAIN 2023

7. What is Organic farming ? COMP 2021

**8. The kharif crops are sown in June and July and harvested in____and____
SQP 2022**

- (a) September and October
- (b) October and November
- (c) March and April
- (d) August and September

9. ____tree plantation is being promoted to check the practice of Shifting cultivation. SQP 2022

- (a) Mango
- (b) Orange
- (c) Apple
- (d) Timber

10. What is mixed farming? MAIN 2024,2018,2017

11. Mention any one advantage of mixed farming. MAIN 2024

12. With reference to tea cultivation, explain the term 'fine pluck'. MAIN 2024

13. Name the Indian state that leads in coffee production. MAIN 2024

**14. The crops which are raised throughout the year are known as____.
COMP 2023**

- (a) Kharif
- (b) Rabi
- (c) Zaid
- (d) Baid

15. ____are all kinds of grass-like plants, which have starchy edible seeds.

- (a) Cereals
- (b) Spices
- (c) Beverages
- (d) Oilseeds SQP 2023

16. India ranks____in the production of cereals in the world. COMP 2024

- (a) first
- (b) second
- (c) third
- (d) fourth

17. ____are cutting taken from old plants and planted to grow new canes. MAIN 2021

- (a) Setts
- (b) Retts
- (c) Ratoons
- (d) Batoons

18. State any two steps being taken by the government to discourage shifting cultivation. MAIN 2024

19. Why is agriculture considered an important sector of Indian economy? (Any two points) MAIN 2024

20. Give two points of difference between Plantation and Mixed Farming. MAIN 2024

21. Give one advantage of transplantation method of sowing rice. MAIN 2023

22. What is 'Ginning'? MAIN 2023

23. Name any two pulses grown in India. MAIN 2023

24. What is meant by 'Retting'? MAIN 2023
25. What kind of soil is required for the cultivation of tea? MAIN 2023
26. Why is pruning necessary for tea plant? MAIN 2023
27. What is Zayad/Zaid cropping season ? MAIN 2022
28. What are the uses of maize besides as an article of food ? SQP 2023
29. Differentiate between Intensive farming and Extensive farming.
MAIN 2023
30. Mention two problems faced by the Indian farmers. MAIN 2023
31. What is Cooperative farming ? SQP 2021
32. Give one reason to explain each of the following: MAIN 2024
- (i) West Bengal is a leading producer of jute.
 - (ii) Millets are fast becoming the popular food crops.
 - (iii) More than two ratoon crops are not advisable for sugarcane farmers.
33. State an important difference between the climatic requirements for growing cotton and jute. MAIN 2022
34. With the reference to the rice cultivation, answer the following :
COMP 2022
- (i) Name the soil suitable for its growth.
 - (ii) Name the state that is the largest producer of this crop in India.
 - (iii) In which cropping season is it generally grown in India.
35. Give any of two effects of globalisation on Indian agriculture? MAIN 2024

Solution

1. (b) Plantation farming

Tea is grown on a large scale in big estates using modern techniques and large labour force. This type of large-scale, commercial farming is known as **plantation farming**.

2. (c) Rabi

Wheat and barley are **Rabi crops**, which are sown in **winter (October–November)** and harvested in **spring**

3. (c) sucrose

In sugarcane, **sucrose** is the main sugar stored in the stem. **Excessive or prolonged rainfall** leads to leaching of sucrose and dilutes its concentration, reducing the sugar content in the crop.

4. (c) Two main cropping seasons

Having **two main cropping seasons (Rabi and Kharif)** is actually an advantage for Indian agriculture, as it allows multiple crop cycles and higher productivity. The other options—dependence on monsoon, small land holdings, and use of traditional farming methods—are genuine problems faced by Indian agriculture.

5. (b) Rice

Rice is the staple food grain for a large part of India, especially in the eastern and southern regions. It forms the major part of daily diet for millions of Indians due to its high calorie content and easy digestibility. Wheat is also important but is more common in northern India.

6. Two advantages of Commercial Farming:

1. **Higher productivity and profitability:** Commercial farming uses advanced techniques, improved seeds, and machinery to produce large quantities of crops, resulting in higher yields and greater profits.
2. **Contribution to the economy:** Surplus production from commercial farming can be exported, generating revenue and supporting overall economic growth.

7. Organic farming is a method of agriculture that relies on natural processes and inputs instead of synthetic chemicals. It avoids the use of chemical fertilizers, pesticides, and genetically modified seeds, and instead uses **compost, manure, crop rotation, and biological pest control** to maintain soil fertility and protect crops.

8. (a) September and October

Kharif crops are sown with the onset of monsoon in **June and July** and harvested in **September and October**.

9. **Timber tree plantation** is being promoted to check the practice of shifting cultivation, as it helps in soil conservation and sustainable forest management.

10. Mixed farming involves the **simultaneous cultivation of crops and rearing of livestock** on the same farm. This system helps farmers diversify their income sources, reduce risks, and make better use of farm resources.

11. One advantage of mixed farming is that it **helps maintain soil fertility** by utilizing animal manure from livestock as natural fertilizer for crops, enhancing productivity and sustainability.

12. In tea cultivation, '**fine pluck**' refers to the practice of **selectively harvesting only the top two leaves and a bud** from the tea plant. This careful picking ensures the production of **high-quality tea** with better flavor and aroma.

13. The Indian state that leads in coffee production is **Karnataka**.

14. (c) **Zaid**. Zaid crops are grown in the short season between the Rabi and Kharif crops, typically during summer months (March to June). These crops,

such as watermelon, cucumber, and vegetables, can be cultivated throughout the year in suitable regions.

15. (a) Cereals.

Cereals are grass-like plants that produce starchy edible seeds, which form a major part of human diets. Examples include rice, wheat, maize, barley, and millet.

16. (c) third.

India ranks **third** in the world in cereal production, after China and the United States. Cereals like rice, wheat, and maize are staple crops contributing significantly to India's agricultural output.

17. (a) Setts.

In sugarcane cultivation, **setts** are pieces or cuttings taken from mature sugarcane stalks and planted in the field to grow new plants. This method ensures the propagation of high-yielding varieties.

18. Two steps being taken by the government to discourage shifting cultivation are:

1. **Promotion of Tree Plantation:** The government encourages timber and other permanent tree plantations in hilly and forested areas to provide alternative sources of income and reduce the need for slash-and-burn farming.
2. **Introduction of Sustainable Farming Practices:** Farmers are provided training, resources, and support for settled agriculture, horticulture, and agroforestry to replace shifting cultivation and maintain soil fertility.

19. Agriculture is considered an important sector of the Indian economy because:

1. **Livelihood and Support:** It supports livestock rearing by providing fodder and suitable conditions. About 70% of rural families depend on agriculture for their livelihood, making it crucial for the rural population.

2. **Employment Generation:** Agriculture is the largest employer in India, providing jobs to around 58.4% of the workforce and contributing significantly to the economy.

20. Two points of difference between **Plantation Farming** and **Mixed Farming** are:

Aspect	Plantation Farming	Mixed Farming
Type of Production	Focuses on a single cash crop grown on a large scale (e.g., tea, coffee, rubber).	Combines crop cultivation and livestock rearing on the same farm.
Purpose	Mainly for commercial purposes and export.	For both subsistence and commercial purposes, diversifying income.

21. One advantage of the **transplantation method** of sowing rice is that it allows farmers to select healthy seedlings and plant them at the right spacing, resulting in **better crop growth and higher yield**.

22. **Ginning** is the process of separating cotton fibers from their seeds, making the fibers ready for spinning into yarn.

23. Two pulses grown in India are **Gram** and **Arhar (Pigeon Pea)**.

24. **Retting** is a microbiological process that softens the bark of plants, making it easier to separate and extract fibers from the stalk.

25. Tea requires **well-drained, deep, fertile soils** such as **loamy, alluvial, laterite, or mountain soils** for optimal growth.

26. Pruning is necessary for tea plants because it **removes the central stem**, encouraging the growth of **lateral branches**, which **facilitates regular hand plucking** and improves yield.

27. The Zaid (or Zaid) cropping season is the **short summer season** between the rabi and kharif crops, during **April, May, and June**. Farmers grow **fruits and vegetables** in this period, taking advantage of the warm, dry months.

28. Besides being used as an article of food, **maize is also used as fodder for cattle** and as a raw material in industries to produce starch, oil, and alcoholic beverages.

29. Differentiate between Intensive farming and Extensive farming.

Intensive Farming	Extensive Farming
Practiced on small land areas with high inputs.	Practiced on large land areas with low inputs.
High yields per hectare.	Lower yields per hectare.
Common in densely populated regions.	Common in sparsely populated regions.

30. Two problems faced by Indian farmers are:

1. **Dependence on unpredictable monsoon** – Erratic rainfall can cause droughts or floods, affecting crop production.
2. **Small land holdings** – Fragmented and small plots limit productivity and make modern farming methods less effective.

31. **Cooperative farming** is a system where farmers work together collectively on their lands to carry out farming activities. Each farmer keeps ownership of their land, but cultivation, management, and marketing are done jointly, and the profits are shared in proportion to the land each farmer contributes.

32. (i) **West Bengal is a leading producer of jute:**

West Bengal has a warm and humid climate with fertile alluvial soil along the Ganga delta, which provides ideal conditions for jute cultivation.

(ii) **Millets are fast becoming popular food crops:**

Millets are drought-resistant, require less water, and are nutritious, making them suitable for areas with water scarcity and for promoting health-conscious diets.

(iii) **More than two ratoon crops are not advisable for sugarcane farmers:**

After two ratoon crops, the yield and quality of sugarcane decline, and the soil gets exhausted of nutrients, making further cropping uneconomical.

33.

Aspect	Cotton	Jute
Climate	Warm and dry climate	Hot and humid climate
Rainfall	Moderate rainfall (50 to 80 cm)	Heavy rainfall (170 to 200 cm)
Temperature	21°C to 27°C	27°C to 34°C

34. (i) **Soil suitable for growth:** Alluvial soil – it retains water well and is rich in nutrients.

(ii) **Largest producing state:** West Bengal.

(iii) **Cropping season:** Kharif season (June to November).

35. Two effects of **globalisation on Indian agriculture** are:

1. **Increased Export Opportunities:** Farmers can sell crops like rice, spices, and cotton in international markets, earning higher income.
2. **Introduction of Modern Technology and Practices:** Globalisation has facilitated access to high-yield seeds, modern machinery, and advanced farming techniques, improving productivity.